INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BALL, GAUZE

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Washington 25, D. C., based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above. The General Services Administration has authorized Federal agencies to use this Interim Federal Specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification JJJ-B-87, dated December 22, 1959.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers a gauze ball with radiopaque insert, suitable for use as a surgical sponge.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 Specifications and standards. --The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

UU-T-116 -- Tape, Paper, Gummed, Water-Resistant.
CCC-G-101 -- Gauze, Absorbent.
PPP-B-636 -- Box, Fiberboard
PPP-T-45 -- Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced.
PPP-T-76 -- Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive, Paper, Water Resistant.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102 -- Preservation, Packaging and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123 -- Marking for Domestic Shipments (Civil agencies).

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 -- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 -- Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

FSC 6510

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Gauze. Gauze sh ll be type III, or IV, Class 1, in accordance with the requirements of Federal Specification CCC-G-101.

3.1.2 Radiopaque insert. The X-ray opaque insert shall be in the form of a monofilament. The monofilament shall be fabricated of either textile or plastic material, and shall be impregnated with an inert, non-toxic substance which is opaque to X-rays. The insert shall appear prominent and conspicuous when covered by at least 5/8 inch of aluminum when tested as specified in 4.4.2. The insert shall not bleed, become tacky, or show any other signs of deterioration when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

3.2 Dimensions.

3.2.1 Gauze. The cut size of the gauze, before forming ball, shall be 12 by 12 inches ± 1/2-inch tolerance for both dimensions, and may be furnished in either one or two pieces.

3.2.2 Radiopaque insert. The monofilament shall be 10 inches ± 1/4 inch in diameter.

3.2.3 Finished ball. The finished size of the ball shall be 1-1/2 inches ± 1/4 inch in diameter.

3.3 Construction. -- Gauze shall be 1-ply and shall have a radiopaque insert placed and secured between the plies as the ball is formed. Ball shall be formed with lip for forceps. The finished product shall have no exposed raw edges.

3.4 Workmanship. -- Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The gauze ball, with radiopaque insert, shall be free from defects which detract from the appearance or which may impair its serviceability.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Supplier responsibilities for inspection. The supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual, auditory, etc., investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.2 Certificates of quality. When available, certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the component or material, listing the specified test method and test results obtained, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor.

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Component	Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Unit of product	Inspection level	AQL
Ball ------	gauze	3.1.1	4.4.1	ball	L2	0
Insert-----	radiopaqueness	3.1.2	4.4.2	ball or insert	L4	0
Insert-----	bleeding	3.1.2	4.4.3	ball or insert	L6	1.0

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for the examination shall be conducted in accordance with instructions furnished by the procuring activity.

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-105.

4.2.3 Components. Sufficient samples of the components shall be selected from each lot of material used in the manufacture of the gauze balls to perform tests as required by the applicable subsidiary specifications or by tests specified herein. When sample size for components covered by the subsidiary specifications is not specified, the sample size for each test shall be as indicated above. No test result shall fall below the minimum or exceed the maximum values specified. The sample unit for testing shall be the quantity necessary to perform all required tests one time each. Not less than 3 samples shall be taken regardless of lot size. Lot sizes are expressed as follows:

Gauze ----------yards
Insert ----------yards

4.2.4 Where possible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

4.3 Examination. -- The gauze balls shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted, as necessary, to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Gauze. -- Gauze shall be tested in accordance with Federal Specification CCC-G-101.

4.4.2 Radiopaque insert (opacity). In testing for opacity, the insert shall be placed on an unexposed X-ray plate and covered with an aluminum ladder ranging in thickness from at least 1/8 to 3/4 inch in steps of 1/8 inch, using an exposure such that the steps of at least 1/4-inch, 3/8-inch, and 5/8-inch are clearly delineated from each other.

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4.4.3 Radiopaque insert (bleeding). In testing for bleeding, tackiness, or other signs of deterioration, the insert shall be sterilized by live steam at a temperature of 250° F. for one hour.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(For civil agency procurement Federal Standard No. 102 shall be referred to for definitions and applications of the various levels of packaging and packing protection for supplies and equipment).

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One hundred balls, as specified, constitute one unit.

5.1.2 Packaging quantities. -- The number of units of issue indicated in table I shall be packaged in each unit, intermediate, and exterior container, as applicable, for the required level of protection specified in procurement document.

TABLE I. -- Packaging quantities

Unit package	Intermediate package	Exterior container
1 unit --------	20 units	40 units

5.1.3 Level A.

5.1.3.1 Unit package. Each unit shall be packaged in a bag fabricated from polyethylene seamless tubing having an average wall thickness of not less than 0.004-inch, with no wall thickness at any point below 0.00325-inch. Excess air shall be expelled or evacuated, and closure effected by heat-sealing.

5.1.3.2 Intermediate package. Intermediate package shall be a carton of appropriate size constructed in accordance with Federal Specification PPP-B-636, class 2, compliance symbol W5c or W5s, style RSC, except that the manufacturer's joint shall be effected either by sealing as specified in 3.3.3.3 of Federal Specification PPP-B-636, or by means of metal stitches. When metal stitches are used, they shall be covered by means of a suitable tape applied over the stitches on the interior surface of the box.

5.1.3.2.1 Closure. Closure shall be effected by means of tape conforming to the requirements of Federal Specification UU-T-116, PPP-T-45, or PPP-T-76. The tape shall be not less than 2 inches wide, and shall be

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applied to both top and bottom so that the center seams are covered their full length. Tape shall extend at least 2 inches onto each of the end panels. Tape will not be required on manufacturer's joint.

5.1.4 Level C. - Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose within the continental limits of the United States of America.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be a box of appropriate size constructed in accordance with Federal Specification PPP-B-636, class 2, compliance symbol V3c or V3s, style RSC.

5.2.1.1.1 Closure. -- Closure shall be as specified in 30.2.2.1 of Federal Specification PPP-B-636, and in addition, the top and bottom center seams shall be closed by means of tape conforming to the requirements of Federal Specification UU-T-116, PPP-T-45, or PPP-T-76. The tape shall be not less than 2 inches wide and shall extend at least 2 inches onto each of the end panels. Strapping will not be required.

5.2.2 Level B. Material packaged as specified in 5.1.3 shall be packed in boxes conforming to Federal Specification PPP-B-636 (type I, class 1, style RSC, for type 2 load.)

5.2.3 Level C. Material packaged as specified in 5.1.4 shall be packed according to the supplier's commercial domestic practice to assure acceptance by the carrier and safe delivery to destination at the lowest transportation rate or rating. Containers shall comply with carrier rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation without assessment of penalty charges for improper packing.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 For civil agencies. In addition to marking required in the contract or purchase order, shipments shall be marked in accordance with Federal Standard No. 123.

5.3.2 For military agencies.

5.3.2.1 Interior packages. Each unit package and intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with section 5 of Military Standard MIL-STD-129. The information required on unit package shall be printed directly on the bag, or on a label inserted within the bag in such manner as to permit ready identification. Contract number and name of contractor shall be shown.

5.3.2.2 Exterior containers. Exterior containers shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-129. The letter "L" shall precede the Federal Stock Number. One space shall be allowed between the letter "L" and the first digit of the stock number. The terms "stock number" or "FSN" shall not be indicated. Service color and service symbol markings are

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required only on direct shipments from the contractor's plant to overseas activities.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title number, and date of this specification.
(b) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing, and marking (see 5.1, 5.2 and 5.3).

6.2 This specification does not include all types, classes, grades, sizes, etc., of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types, etc., which are normally procured to meet Federal Government requirements.

6.3 Transportation description. Transportation description applicable to this item is:

Dressing Surgeons'

Carload minimum weight 24,000 pounds subject to Rule 34 of the Uniform Freight Classification.

Truckload minimum weight 24,000 pounds subject to Rule 115 of the National Motor Freight Classification.

NOTICE (See last page)

MILITARY INTERESTS:
Army --M
Navy --Md
Air Force.

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(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, and Auburn, Wash.

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